

Lab 8. Group Policies (Group Policy)

IT Infrastructure Management (W04IST–SI0826G)

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1 Lab Objectives

1. Learn how to apply Group Policy settings.
2. Learn the rules that control the scope of settings defined in policies:
 - inheritance,
 - setting permissions.

2 Exercises

2.1 Order of Policy Application. Resolving Conflicts

During this exercise you will see how to configure a user's computer using settings stored in Group Policy Objects. You will also check what happens when there is a conflict (different values for the same setting) between two GPOs.

1. (DC1) Open the Group Policy Management console (GPMC). Expand: Forest: contoso.interna, Domains, contoso.internal, Group Policy Objects.
2. In the Group Policy Objects container create two GPOs: *BlockCP* and *AllowCP*.
3. In both GPOs configure the setting “User / Policies / Administrative Templates / Control Panel / Prohibit access to Control Panel”. In the first GPO enable the setting (*Enabled*), in the second GPO disable it (*Disabled*).
4. Verify the settings: in the “Group Policy Objects” container click each GPO and open the “Settings” tab in the right pane. You will see only the settings that were explicitly configured (enabled or disabled).
5. In the following steps you will test the effects of both policies.

Note: After each change to Group Policy, sign in on CL1, check whether you have access to the Control Panel, then **sign out** (do not switch users, do not lock the screen, do not close the Remote Desktop window):

6. Link the *BlockCP* GPO to OU Sweden/Marketing. Right-click OU Sweden/Marketing and choose *Link an existing GPO*. Verify that Marketing users do not have access to the Control Panel.

7. Link the *AllowCP* object to OU Sweden/Marketing. Did anything change? Click OU Sweden and look at the “Linked Group Policy Objects” tab. What is the order of the objects? Was AllowCP linked at the top or at the bottom?
8. On the “Linked GPOs” tab change the order of the GPOs. Check what happens after reordering by signing in as a user from the Marketing department.
9. Remove both GPO links from OU Sweden/Marketing.

Verification: Click each GPO. Check that the “Links” section on the “Scope” tab is empty.

2.2 Inheritance of Policies

In this task you will observe how settings from parent Organizational Units are applied to child OUs. You will also see what happens when GPOs are linked at different OUs.

Note: You do not need to sign out of CL1, if you run `gpupdate /force` after each Group Policy change.

1. (DC1) Link the *BlockCP* GPO to the contoso.internal domain.
2. (CL1) Sign in as a user from EMEA/Marketing. Is the Control Panel disabled? Sign in as the domain administrator. Does the domain administrator have access to the Control Panel?

After each subsequent Group Policy change, check the effect on CL1.

3. (DC1) Link the *AllowCP* GPO to OU Sweden.
4. (DC1) Link the *BlockCP* GPO to OU Sweden/Marketing.
5. (CL1) Open a command prompt (CMD) and run:

```
gpupdate /force
gpresult /h result.html
result.html
```

Analyze the output: which GPOs were applied?

6. (DC1) Go to OU Sweden/Marketing and open the *Group Policy Inheritance* tab. Observe the order in which policies are applied.
7. In which order are inherited GPOs from different OUs processed? Which GPO’s settings take priority?
8. **Cleanup** (DC1) Remove the *BlockCP* link from OU Sweden/Marketing and remove AllowCP from OU Sweden.
9. (CL1) Refresh policies.

2.3 Controlling Inheritance

The previous exercise showed that child OUs can override settings configured on parent OUs. Sometimes we want to change how inheritance works — for example, to block parent GPOs from being applied, or to enforce parent-level settings.

1. (DC1) In the context menu of OU Sweden select “Block inheritance”. What changed on the screen?
2. View the *Group Policy Inheritance* tab for OU Sweden and Marketing. See which policies are applied and in what order.
3. (DC1) On the domain-level *BlockCP* link properties enable *Enforced*.
4. View the *Group Policy Inheritance* tab for OU Sweden and Marketing. Check which policies are applied and in what order.
5. (DC1) Link *AllowCP* at the OU Sweden level and enable enforcement for it.
6. (DC1) Go to OU Marketing and view the *Group Policy Inheritance* tab. Observe the order of applied policies.
7. What is the difference between normal inherited settings and enforced settings?
8. (CL1) Refresh Group Policy and check the result.
9. **Cleanup:** Disable all enforcement and inheritance blocks.
10. (DC1) Remove the *AllowCP* link from OU Sweden.

2.4 Filtering by Security Groups

In this task you will observe how to limit the application of GPO settings to a selected group of users.

1. (CL1) Run `gpupdate /force`
2. (CL1) Check whether you can access the Control Panel when logged in as `contoso\DAdmin1`.
3. (DC1) In the Group Policy Objects container select the *BlockCP* GPO, and on the *Scope* tab under *Security Filtering* replace *Authenticated Users* with the groups *EMEA Marketing* and *Domain Computers*.

Explanation: If you remove *Authenticated Users*, computers will lose read access to the GPO *BlockCP*, so you must also add the *Domain Computers* group.
4. (CL1) After refreshing policies, verify that administrators and Marketing staff have access to the Control Panel as intended.
5. **Cleanup:** (DC1) In the *BlockCP* GPO restore *Authenticated Users* in the *Security Filtering* section.

2.5 Filtering Using Permissions

In this task you will observe how to **deny** the application of a GPO to a selected security group.

Compare this with the previous task.

1. (DC1) Go to the Delegation tab, click Advanced, and grant the permission: Domain Admins::Apply Group Policy::Deny.
2. (CL1) After refreshing policies check whether Admin1 or the main administrator account has access to the Control Panel.
3. Consider the differences between this approach and the previous approach. In which situations is each solution appropriate?